

Backend Configuration & Data Setup – SLA Condition Configuration

SLA Condition Configuration

Overview

After creating the **Incident Resolution – Virtual Agent Governance** SLA Definition, the next step is to configure the SLA lifecycle conditions. These conditions determine **when the SLA starts, pauses, stops, and resets** during the lifecycle of an Incident.

Properly configuring these conditions ensures that the SLA timer accurately reflects the time available for resolving an Incident, while supporting proactive monitoring, governance, and reporting.

Objective

The objectives of configuring SLA conditions are to:

- Automatically start SLA tracking when an Incident is created.
 - Pause SLA timing when the Incident is waiting on the requester.
 - Stop SLA tracking once the Incident is resolved.
 - Reset the SLA if the Incident is reopened.
 - Ensure accurate business-hour SLA calculations.
-

Navigation

Navigate to:

Service Level Management → SLA Definitions

Open the **Incident Resolution – Virtual Agent Governance** SLA and scroll to the **Conditions** section.

SLA Conditions

1. Start Condition

The SLA should begin tracking as soon as an Incident is created and becomes active.

Configuration

Field	Value
-------	-------

Start Condition Active = True

Purpose

- Automatically attaches the SLA to active Incident records.
- Starts the SLA timer immediately after Incident creation.
- Begins monitoring resolution time.

2. Pause Condition

The SLA timer should pause whenever the Incident is waiting for information or action from the requester.

Configuration

Field	Value
-------	-------

Pause Condition	State = On Hold AND On Hold Reason = Awaiting Caller (or Waiting for Customer, depending on your instance)
------------------------	--

Purpose

- Stops the SLA timer while waiting for the customer.
- Prevents unfair SLA consumption during customer delays.
- Resumes automatically when the Incident becomes active again.

3. Stop Condition

The SLA should stop when the Incident has been successfully resolved.

Configuration

Field **Value**

Stop Condition State = Resolved

Purpose

- Ends SLA tracking.
- Records the total business time consumed.
- Calculates whether the SLA was met or breached.

4. Reset Condition

If an Incident is reopened after being resolved, the SLA should restart.

Configuration

Field **Value**

Reset Condition State changes to Active (or Reopened = True, depending on your Incident process)

Purpose

- Restarts SLA tracking for reopened incidents.
- Ensures additional work is measured accurately.
- Maintains correct SLA compliance records.

SLA Lifecycle

The configured SLA follows this lifecycle:

1. **Start** – When an Incident becomes **Active**.
2. **Pause** – When the Incident is **On Hold** awaiting the requester.
3. **Resume** – When the Incident returns to an active working state.
4. **Stop** – When the Incident reaches the **Resolved** state.
5. **Reset** – If the Incident is reopened for further work.

Validation

After configuring the conditions, verify that:

- The SLA starts automatically when a new Incident is created.
- The SLA pauses when the Incident is placed **On Hold** awaiting the customer.
- The SLA resumes when work continues.
- The SLA stops when the Incident is resolved.
- The SLA resets correctly if the Incident is reopened.
- Business hours are applied according to the **IT Support Business Hours** schedule.

Expected Outcome

After completing the SLA condition configuration:

- SLA tracking begins automatically for active Incidents.

- Timers pause during approved waiting periods.
 - Resolution time is measured accurately.
 - Reopened Incidents receive fresh SLA tracking when required.
 - SLA monitoring supports notifications, Virtual Agent interactions, dashboards, and governance reporting.
-

Conclusion

Configuring the **Start**, **Pause**, **Stop**, and **Reset** conditions ensures that the **Incident Resolution – Virtual Agent Governance** SLA behaves consistently throughout the Incident lifecycle. These conditions provide accurate SLA measurement based on business rules, enabling proactive breach awareness, reliable reporting, improved accountability, and audit-ready governance within the ServiceNow platform.